

Task 2: Multiple Sequence Alignment (MSA) of Hemoglobin Beta Proteins

1. Introduction

Multiple Sequence Alignment (MSA) is a bioinformatics technique used to align three or more biological sequences (protein or nucleic acid) to identify regions of similarity, conserved residues, evolutionary relationships, and functional motifs. In this study, Hemoglobin Beta (HBB) protein sequences from five different species were analyzed using Clustal Omega.

2. Objective

To perform Multiple Sequence Alignment of Hemoglobin Beta proteins from Human, Rat, Mouse, Sheep, and Chicken using Clustal Omega and identify conserved regions and evolutionary relationships among the selected species.

3. Protein Sequences Used

- Human (*Homo sapiens*) – Hemoglobin Beta (HBB)
- Rat (*Rattus norvegicus*) – Hemoglobin Beta (HBB)
- Mouse (*Mus musculus*) – Hemoglobin Beta (HBB)
- Sheep (*Ovis aries*) – Hemoglobin Beta (HBB)
- Chicken (*Gallus gallus*) – Hemoglobin Beta (HBB)

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MVHLTPEEKSAVTALWGKVNVDEVGGEALGRLLVVYPWTQRFFESFGDLSTPDAMGNPK
VKAHGKKVLGAFSDGLAHLDNLKGTFTLSELHCDKLHVDPENFRLLGNVLVCVLAHHFG
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>sp|P02089|HBB2_MOUSE Hemoglobin subunit beta-2 OS=Mus musculus OX=10090 GN=Hbb-b2 PE=1 SV=2
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>sp|P02075|HBB_SHEEP Hemoglobin subunit beta OS=Ovis aries OX=9940 GN=HBB PE=1 SV=2
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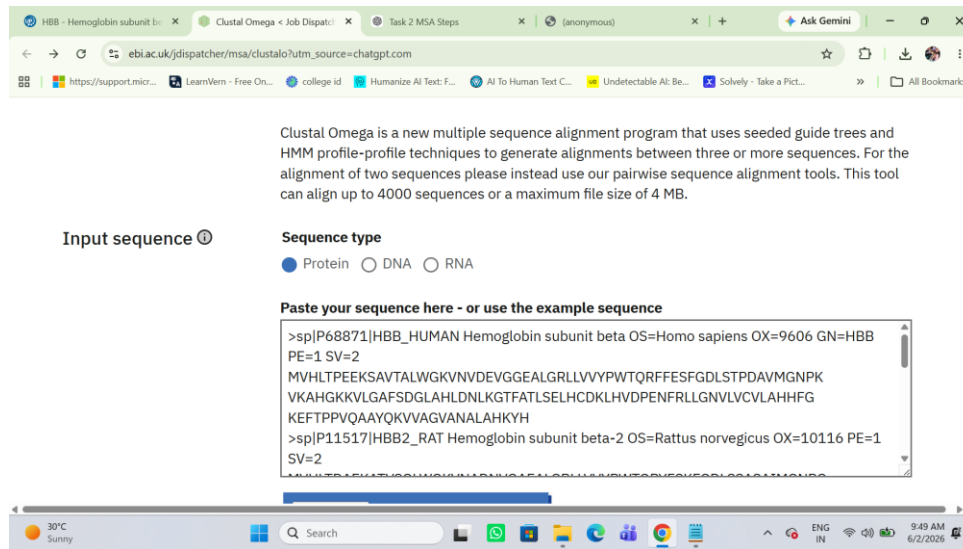
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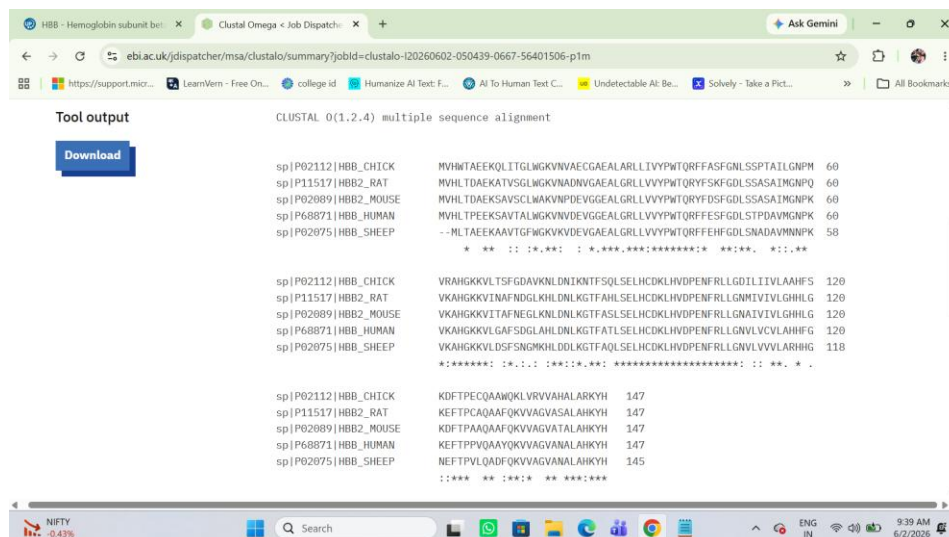
4. Methodology

1. Downloaded Hemoglobin Beta protein sequences from UniProt.
2. Combined all sequences into a single FASTA file.
3. Performed Multiple Sequence Alignment using Clustal Omega.
4. Analyzed conserved residues and motifs.
5. Generated Guide Tree and Phylogenetic Tree.
6. Interpreted evolutionary relationships.



5. Results and Analysis

The alignment revealed several conserved amino acid residues across all species. In Clustal Omega output, '*' indicates fully conserved residues, ':' indicates strong similarity, and '.' indicates weak similarity. The presence of many conserved positions indicates the functional importance of Hemoglobin Beta.



6. Conserved Region Interpretation

The presence of numerous conserved amino acids demonstrates that critical structural and functional regions of Hemoglobin Beta have been preserved throughout evolution. These residues contribute to oxygen transport and protein stability.

7. Guide Tree and Phylogenetic Analysis

Mouse and Rat formed the closest cluster, indicating a close evolutionary relationship. Human and Sheep also showed high sequence similarity. Chicken formed a separate branch and appeared more distant from the mammalian species. This suggests that mammalian hemoglobin proteins are more closely related to each other than to avian hemoglobin proteins.

